

SELCO FOUNDATION

Founded: 2010

Sector: Sustainable Energy,
Rural Livelihoods,
Healthcare Access,
Climate Resilience,
Poverty Alleviation

SELCO Foundation was established in 2010 in Bengaluru by Dr. Harish Hande as an open-source innovation lab to address energy poverty and its links with health, education and livelihood deprivation in India.

Operating at the intersection of sustainability and poverty alleviation, the Foundation uses Decentralised Renewable Energy (DRE) as a catalyst to democratise essential services for last-mile communities. Its ecosystem approach — innovating on technology, financing, ownership and policy — has so far impacted over 2 million people and is now being replicated across the Global South.

Energy Poverty & Last-Mile Access

Healthcare for the Underserved

Climate Vulnerability & Adaptation

Livelihoods & Asset Ownership

Decentralised Innovation & Open Source

SELCO Foundation Initiatives

SELCAP — Sustainable Energy-led Climate Action Programme

Flagship programme prioritising clean energy access (SDG 7) as a means of lifting people out of poverty while supporting climate adaptation and mitigation (SDG 13). Anchors all of SELCO's livelihoods, health and education work in a climate-justice lens.

Energy for Livelihoods

Solar-powered sewing machines, millet processing units, cold storages, roti rollers, sugarcane juicers, irrigation pumps and spraying drones — converting energy consumers into asset-owning micro-entrepreneurs. Improved livelihoods for 900,000+ people.

SELCO Impact Fund

Registered in 2016 to deploy patient capital — equity and debt — to last-mile energy access enterprises. Closes the financing gap between philanthropic grants and commercial capital for early-stage DRE entrepreneurs.

Energy for Health

Solar-powering of 1,300+ public health facilities across Karnataka, Odisha, Meghalaya, Nagaland and Manipur. Goal: 25,000 health centres by 2026-27 in partnership with IKEA Foundation and the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare; primary focus on maternal labour rooms.

SELCO Incubation Programme

Established 2012 to nurture aspiring clean-energy enterprises that deploy and maintain sustainable solutions for underserved communities. Builds the supply-side ecosystem through mentorship, technical assistance and patient capital.

Global Replication & Policy Influence

Active replication in the Philippines, Tanzania and Sub-Saharan Africa. Knowledge sharing via the Solutions Portal and collaborations with WHO, IRENA, SEforALL and Global SDG7 Hubs to influence national and global policy on DRE.

Impact at a Glance

7M+

People impacted cumulatively¹

7,933

Health facilities solar-enabled, 13 states²

3,845

DRE livelihood interventions FY24-25²

10,000+

Micro-entrepreneurs financed⁴

8,100+

Stakeholders trained FY 2024-25²

15+

Indian states & 10+ countries^{5,6}



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